

BIOL 2406: Computational Techniques in Genome Analysis (CTGA)

I hate assigning zeroes. For this reason, I want to be hyper-clear on expectations, thus this document. Please read it carefully. You'll be given a copy in class to sign. Detach the portion below the dashed line and return it to me.

I (the student) understand that **50% of my grade is based on timely completion of five skills modules**, graded on these components:

- Following instructions: Be sure that all parts of each assignment as indicated in the instructions (Canvas and Github) are included and complete.
- Inclusion of a readme file that clearly indicates the absolute path of each part of the assignment, as well as any other requested information. **If a readme file is not included, the assignment is given a zero.**
- User friendliness (extremely important "best practice"): 1) Name files concisely, descriptively, and with no illegal characters; 2) Hash-comment work appropriately; 3) Delete extraneous lines of output. **UNIX or RStudio work that is not hash-commented, and/or contains lines and lines of extraneous text will receive a zero.**
- On-time submission: Show professionalism by keeping up with due dates. Each student is given **one** penalty-free 48-hour extension. For the other five modules, there is a 1-point deduction if submitted within 24 hours of the due date; 2-point deduction if submitted within 48 hours of the due date. **No work will be accepted after 48 hours.**
- Submission to correct place: Work submitted to the cluster must be in your student directory and with permissions set so that I can see it, and work submitted to Github must be in a public repository, **otherwise I cannot view it and it will receive a zero.**

Adhering to these components will not only enhance your grade but will train you in the professional "best practices" in the field of bioinformatics and computational biology!

I understand that **20% of my grade is based on completion of in-class quizzes or worksheets**, as follows:

- There will be one in-class quiz or worksheet every session starting with the third class (22 total).
- There are no make-ups if you miss class, but the three lowest scores are dropped.
- This policy means everyone has **three no-questions-asked absences** available, whether you are ill, have an emergency, are using a Wellness Day, or just aren't feeling it. Any absence beyond the three will count against you, regardless of the reason.

I understand that **10% of my grade is based on two presentations to the class**, as follows:

- One solo presentation (5%) consisting of a two- to three-minute demo of an interesting use of UNIX, RStudio, or markdown commands
- One presentation (5%) with a partner on a topic chosen from a list
- Presented at the beginning of class on two dates, chosen from a sign-up sheet

I understand that **10% of my grade is based on an in-class exam**:

- Will test my conceptual understanding of analyses performed in class and their interpretation.
- Will be given approximately three weeks before finals

I understand that **10% of my grade is based on a final take-home exam**:

- I'll update my resumé to include the new skills I acquired in class and upload it to Claude
- Claude will be prompted to play the role of interviewer, asking me questions to gage my understanding of the skills I learned and how I applied them.

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I have read the above and understand its relevance to the determination of my grade in this class.

Signature: _____

Date: _____